PDF forms are not compatible with the Google Chrome PDF viewer plug-in. Chrome users should save the form, then reopen and complete with Adobe reader.

EE/RPF

For use from May/November 2027

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Student personal code:

Extended essay - Reflection and progress form

Student: *This form is to be completed by you and your supervisor during the progress and completion of the extended essay. It records your progress through the extended essay process and includes your reflective statement addressing your extended essay experience. You must undertake three formal reflection sessions with your supervisor: The first formal reflection session should focus on your initial ideas and how you plan to undertake your research; the interim reflection session takes place once a significant amount of your research has been completed, and the final session will be in the form of a viva voce, once you have completed and handed in your extended essay. This document acts as a record in supporting the authenticity of your work. Following the viva voce, you write a* ***reflective statement*** *of no more than 500 words., which must be included on the RPF.*

The completion of this form is a mandatory requirement of the extended essay. It must be submitted together with the completed essay. The reflective statement will then be assessed under Criterion E. Students and supervisors should be aware that a mark of 0 will be awarded by the examiner for criterion E if the RPF is blank or the reflective statement is written in a language other than that of the accompanying essay.

Supervisor: *You must have three reflection sessions with each student, one early in the process, an interim meeting and then the final viva voce. Other check-in sessions are permitted but do not need to be recorded on this sheet. After each reflection session you must record the month that the reflection session took place, the student's year of DP study at that time and initial the form.*
By submitting this student work for assessment, you are taking responsibility for its authenticity. No piece of student work should be uploaded/submitted to the e-Coursework system if its authenticity is in doubt.

First reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Interim reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Final reflection session – Viva voce

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

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Reflective statement

(No more than 500 words, written in the same language as the accompanying extended essay)

My Hong Kong upbringing garnered my interest in social issues such as refugee rights and the housing crisis. Ultimately, I chose microfinance due to my interest in poverty alleviation strategies and social entrepreneurship. World Studies allows me to conduct interdisciplinary research in Geography and Economics, allowing for further depth. Discussion with my supervisor helped me to refine my research question and to gain a larger understanding of my topic through reading research papers on microfinance and poverty. This led to a refinement of my research question to focus on microfinance's impact on gender inequalities rather than poverty because it resonated more with me and is more nuanced and complex, and allowed better structured research and arguments. By the time of my first draft I had a deeper understanding of microfinance and why gender inequalities restrict access to banking services. But I found it difficult to link the many sources which gave perspective and depth to the topic to a coherent structure which linked my points to the most appropriate sources. To do this I learned to limit my sources to those which were relevant and not outdated and to follow a writing structure to help me organise my ideas and sources. At this point most of my sources were academic journals, so I tried to branch out to books and articles. These changes gave me a better idea of how to answer my research question. Despite modifying my research question and struggling to manage resources, I really enjoyed researching my EE topic. Overcoming these challenges gave me a deeper understanding of microfinance and its implications for women. I felt I had a personal connection to my research topic due to my gender and my interest in advocating for gender equality. However, I am aware of limitations to my research. I could not conduct any research beyond relying on secondary sources such as academic journals due to the main focus of my Essay being on low income countries. Nevertheless, using journal articles which did conduct primary research allowed me to make connections between them, creating a conclusion which is not limited by small sample size. I believe this is important as the topic is one of global significance. If I had the opportunity to conduct further research, I would like to expand it beyond local manifestations and to conduct primary research. Overall, this was a rewarding experience which has honed my analysis skills and global consciousness.

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